

Acme Corp - Acceptable Use Policy

Policy ID: ACME-IT-002

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Last Revised: January 1, 2026

Approved By: David Park, Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

Applies To: All Acme Corp employees, contractors, interns, and authorized third parties with access to Acme Corp technology resources

1. Purpose

This policy defines the acceptable use of Acme Corp's technology resources, including computers, networks, email, internet access, software, and cloud services. The goal is to protect employees, partners, and the company from the risks associated with misuse of technology while enabling productive work.

This policy supplements the Information Security Policy (ACME-IT-001) and the Code of Conduct (ACME-HR-005).

2. Scope

This policy applies to all technology resources owned, leased, or operated by Acme Corp, including but not limited to:

- Desktop computers, laptops, tablets, and mobile devices
- Company-provided software and cloud services
- Email systems (Google Workspace)
- Messaging platforms (Slack)
- Internet access through company networks or VPN
- Printers, scanners, and other peripherals
- Company phone systems and conferencing tools
- File storage systems (Google Drive, shared network drives)
- Development and production infrastructure (AWS, GitHub Enterprise)

This policy also applies to personal devices used to access company resources (BYOD), as outlined in the Information Security Policy (ACME-IT-001, Section 4.2).

3. General Use Principles

3.1 Company Resources Are Company Property

All technology resources provided by Acme Corp remain the property of the company. Acme Corp reserves the right to monitor, access, and review all data stored on or transmitted through company systems, in accordance with applicable law. Employees should have no expectation of privacy when using company technology resources.

3.2 Primary Business Use

Company technology resources are provided primarily for business use. Limited personal use is permitted provided it:

- Does not interfere with job duties or productivity
- Does not consume excessive bandwidth or storage
- Does not violate any company policy or applicable law
- Does not create security risks for the company
- Occurs during breaks or outside of core working hours when possible

3.3 User Responsibility

Each user is responsible for:

- All activity conducted under their user accounts
- Protecting their login credentials and not sharing them with anyone
- Reporting any suspected security incidents or policy violations immediately
- Keeping company devices physically secure at all times
- Complying with all applicable policies, including this one

4. Internet Usage

4.1 Acceptable Internet Use

The internet is provided to support business activities, including:

- Research and information gathering for work-related purposes
- Communication with clients, partners, and colleagues
- Professional development and training

- Accessing cloud-based business applications

4.2 Prohibited Internet Activities

The following internet activities are prohibited on company networks and devices:

- Visiting websites containing pornographic, sexually explicit, or obscene content
- Downloading or streaming pirated content (music, movies, software, games)
- Engaging in illegal activities of any kind
- Accessing the dark web or anonymizing services (Tor, I2P) without explicit IT Security approval
- Using company resources for cryptocurrency mining
- Participating in online gambling
- Engaging in activities that consume excessive bandwidth for non-business purposes (e.g., streaming 4K video, large personal downloads)
- Circumventing network security controls, content filters, or firewalls
- Downloading software not on the Acme Corp Approved Software List (see Information Security Policy, ACME-IT-001, Section 7.1)

4.3 Web Filtering

Acme Corp uses web filtering technology to block access to categories of websites that pose security risks or are inappropriate for the workplace. If a legitimate business site is blocked, employees may submit an unblock request through the IT ticketing system.

5. Email Usage

5.1 Acceptable Email Use

Company email (Google Workspace) should be used for business communications. Employees must:

- Use professional language and tone in all email communications
- Include appropriate disclaimers when communicating with external parties
- Use the company email address for all work-related correspondence
- Follow data classification guidelines when sharing information via email (see Information Security Policy, ACME-IT-001, Section 2)

5.2 Prohibited Email Activities

The following email activities are prohibited:

- Sending, forwarding, or storing messages containing harassment, threats, or discriminatory content
- Sending chain letters, spam, or unsolicited bulk messages
- Using company email for personal commercial purposes or side businesses
 - Auto-forwarding company email to personal email accounts (this is technically blocked; attempting to circumvent the block is a policy violation)
- Sending Confidential or Restricted data to personal email accounts
- Impersonating another person or using a false identity in email communications
 - Opening suspicious attachments or clicking links in emails from unknown senders (report to phishing@acmecorp.com)

5.3 Email Retention

Company emails are retained for 7 years in accordance with the Acme Corp Data Retention Schedule. Employees should not delete emails that may be relevant to legal, regulatory, or compliance matters. When a legal hold is in place, all relevant emails must be preserved regardless of normal retention schedules.

6. Messaging and Collaboration Platforms

6.1 Slack Usage

Slack is Acme Corp's primary internal communication platform. Guidelines for use:

- Keep conversations in appropriate channels (not via DMs when the information benefits the team)
- Use threads to keep conversations organized
- Do not share Restricted data in Slack; use approved secure channels instead
- Treat Slack messages with the same professionalism as email
- Set your status to reflect your availability
- Mute non-essential channels during focused work time

6.2 Video Conferencing (Zoom)

- Use Zoom for meetings with external parties; Google Meet for internal-only meetings
- Enable waiting rooms for meetings with external participants
- Do not record meetings without informing all participants
- Be mindful of your background and environment during video calls

7. Software and Application Use

7.1 Approved Software Only

Only software from the Acme Corp Approved Software List may be installed on company devices. The process for requesting new software is outlined in the Information Security Policy (ACME-IT-001, Section 7.1).

7.2 Software Licensing

All software used on company devices must be properly licensed. Employees must:

- Not install pirated, cracked, or unlicensed software on company devices
- Not share license keys or software installations with unauthorized parties
- Report any licensing concerns to IT immediately

7.3 Cloud Services

- Use only approved cloud services (Google Drive, AWS, GitHub Enterprise, etc.) for storing and sharing company data
- Do not use personal cloud storage (Dropbox personal, iCloud, OneDrive personal) for company files
- Do not create accounts on new SaaS platforms using your company email without IT approval

7.4 AI Tools and Generative AI

Employees may use company-approved AI tools for work tasks. When using AI tools:

- Never input Confidential or Restricted data into AI tools that are not on the approved list
- Review AI-generated output for accuracy before using it in business communications or deliverables
- Comply with the Acme Corp AI Usage Guidelines (available on the IT intranet)
- Report any AI tools that you'd like to use for work to IT for security evaluation

Currently approved AI tools:

- GitHub Copilot (engineering team, via enterprise license)
- Google Gemini (via Google Workspace, enterprise tier)
- Custom internal AI assistants (via Acme AI Platform)

Unapproved tools include but are not limited to: free-tier ChatGPT, Claude, and other public AI services that may retain input data.

8. Social Media

8.1 Personal Social Media on Company Devices

Accessing personal social media during breaks is permitted, provided it complies with the general use principles in Section 3. However:

- Do not post company confidential information on social media
- Do not represent personal opinions as official Acme Corp positions
- Be mindful of information visible in screenshots or photos taken in the office

8.2 Official Social Media

Only authorized Marketing and Communications team members may post on official Acme Corp social media accounts. See Code of Conduct (ACME-HR-005, Section 11) for details.

9. Data Storage and Handling

9.1 Approved Storage Locations

Company data must be stored only in approved locations:

Data Classification	Approved Storage
Public	Google Drive, company website,
Internal	Google Drive (company), Slack,
Confidential	Google Drive (restricted shari
Restricted	Encrypted databases with acces

9.2 Prohibited Storage

Do not store company data in:

- Personal email accounts
- Personal cloud storage (Dropbox, iCloud, OneDrive personal)
- USB drives or external hard drives (without encryption and IT approval)
- Personal devices (except via approved MDM-enrolled devices per BYOD policy)
- Unauthorized third-party services

9.3 Data Sharing

When sharing data externally:

- Use Acme Corp-approved file sharing methods (Google Drive shared links with appropriate permissions)
- Set link expiration dates for external shares (maximum 30 days)
- Use password-protected files for Confidential data shared externally

- Never share Restricted data externally without CISO approval

10. Printing and Physical Documents

- Print only when necessary; prefer digital documents
- Retrieve printed documents promptly from shared printers
- Shred documents containing Confidential or Restricted information using the secure shredding bins
- Do not leave printed Confidential or Restricted documents unattended

11. Remote and Mobile Access

11.1 VPN Usage

Remote employees must use the company VPN when accessing company resources from outside the office. See Information Security Policy (ACME-IT-001, Section 5.1) for details.

11.2 Mobile Device Usage

Employees using mobile devices (phones, tablets) to access company resources must:

- Enroll in Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- Maintain a screen lock (minimum 6-digit PIN or biometric)
- Keep the device's operating system up to date
- Report lost or stolen devices immediately

11.3 Public Locations

When working from public locations (coffee shops, airports, co-working spaces):

- Always use the VPN
- Use a privacy screen on your laptop
- Do not leave devices unattended
- Be cautious about having sensitive conversations that could be overheard
- Never access Restricted data from public Wi-Fi, even with VPN

12. Monitoring and Compliance

12.1 Company Right to Monitor

Acme Corp reserves the right to monitor all activity on company technology resources, including but not limited to:

- Email content and metadata
- Internet browsing history
- File access and transfers
- Application usage
- Slack messages
- Login activity and access logs

Monitoring is conducted in accordance with applicable laws and is used to:

- Protect company assets and data
- Ensure compliance with company policies
- Investigate suspected policy violations or security incidents
- Respond to legal or regulatory requirements

12.2 Audits

The IT Security team conducts periodic audits of technology resource usage. Audits may be triggered by:

- Routine scheduled reviews
- Unusual activity detected by monitoring systems
- Reports of suspected policy violations
- Legal or regulatory requirements

13. Enforcement

13.1 Violation Reporting

Employees should report suspected violations of this policy to:

- IT Security: security@acmecorp.com or extension x4700
- Their direct manager
- The anonymous Ethics Hotline: (555) 246-8100

13.2 Consequences of Violation

Violations of this Acceptable Use Policy may result in:

- First offense (minor): Written warning and mandatory refresher training

- Second offense or moderate violation: Restricted technology access and formal disciplinary action
- Severe violation: Immediate suspension of technology access, disciplinary action up to and including termination, and potential legal action

The severity of consequences will depend on the nature and impact of the violation, whether it was intentional, and the employee's history.

14. Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy must be requested in writing to the CISO and approved in advance. Approved exceptions will be documented and reviewed quarterly.

15. Policy Compliance and Questions

Employees with questions about this policy should contact the IT Security team at security@acmecorp.com or extension x4700.

This policy is subject to change at the discretion of Acme Corp management. Employees will be notified of material changes via email and the Acme HR Portal.